

From The Digit Forum

Subject **How English is a Language for Nuts**

saROMan

Resident Techie

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English is the most widely used language in the history of our planet. But let's face it—English is a crazy language. There is no egg in an eggplant nor ham in a hamburger; neither apple nor pine in a pineapple. Sweetmeats are candies while sweetbreads, which aren't sweet, are meat.

You have to marvel at the unique lunacy of a language in which your house can burn up as it burns down, and in which you fill in a form by filling it out.

English was invented by people, not computers, and it reflects the creativity of the human race (which, of course, isn't a race at all). That is why, when the stars are out, they are visible, but when the lights are out, they are invisible. And why, when I wind up my watch, I start it, but when I wind up this essay, I end it.

Kl@w-24

Digitized!

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diabOlic666

In-House Geek

yawns

Don't have time to read whole post. Whatever is written, we still gotta communicate in English

klinux

Resident Techie

In a couple of years, the number of people speaking Indian English, with all Indianised accent, which has mostly come down to neutral, would outgrow the number of English speakers like the Americans, Brits and Aussies.

Hinglish / Tamlish would be dominant in just a few years. There was a joke where we had outsourced our call centres and had Americans helping solve our probs over the phone. They would have all Indian names, and classes on how to talk Hinglish.

For the Tamil guys: think abt American call centre agents having alias names like Kandaswamy, Munniamma, etc. and having to learn Tamil slang. That would be fun.

For Better Or For Worse

I have been reading your magazine for close to 18 months now. I have always been impressed by the quality of your magazine—the text and CD content, and the constant innovation, which is what it takes to be the king of the hill.

Digit has always been loyal to its subscribers—the December '03 bonus issue with *Ice Age*, the June '04 issue with the freeware and PDF CDs, and then the free DVD, and the revised content and layout of the magazine from August.

The places you have improved are many. The magazine content is much better. The articles have greater relevance for us lesser geeks. Many of the technologies have reviewed are more relevant to home users or small businessmen and SoHo users, rather than the lengthy articles on gadgets and technologies that would take a long time to make an impact in the Indian market.



The clear demarcation of the articles under 'Digital Passion', 'Digital Tools', 'Digital Business', etc. is very useful. New columns such as '30 days with...', 'Old Way Tech Way', are quite innovative and fun to read.

And obviously, the DVD is a big boost because you can give us more software, games, whitepapers...

The Digit Patron Programme is an excellent step in cementing our relationship. It's a win-win situation. The quality of response by the *Digit* staff has always been amazing and should continue to be so.

And now for the downside. I really

think that your product reviews are steadily becoming worse. Not only are they not as detailed as before, the replacing of the 'Best Value' and 'Best Performance' awards with 'Best Buy' does not help the reader.

Even though you have employed better colours and fonts, the new layout of the magazine is definitely much more cluttered.

I hope *Digit* continues to innovate, and at the same time, learn from feedback to forever retain their place as India's best tech magazine. Best of luck, *Digit*.

R Harshavardhan,
Hyderabad

When My Landline Is Listed, Why Not My Mobile?

With reference to Sachin Kalbag's editorial in the October issue ('I Got Your Mobile Number'), I would like to say this: Think of landlines. Do all the numbers find mention in the directory? Furthermore, how regularly is the directory published?

The companies supposed to operate at the cutting edge of communications technology do not have a system to ascertain outstandings! They are adept at sending you your bills, but cannot use couriers to deliver your directory. Perhaps the bottom-heavy 'nigams' find this a way of saving on stationery and printing!

Why do the mobiles not make a beginning by making numbers available on their Web sites? The argument that not all users are net-savvy does not hold water. Surely the mobile user is more savvy than the plain landliner!

Mobile spam is nothing new. Advertisers can send spam to numbers in a simple, unitary progression starting with, say, 00001, prefixing the service provider's code for the town, which is a constant anyway. It is the option of being able to mask the sender's ID that needs to be prohibited.

When the US can do it with their "do not call" registry, why can't we?

All said and done, a mobile is only a telephone without wires. So where is the hassle? India needs sensible laws, smart and unfettered law enforcement, a sensitive judiciary and most of all, national pride in being law-abiding citizens.

Ram G Prasad,
Chennai